

Anesthetics



What is it?

Anesthetics numb the skin. They can be found in products that are used on the skin or given by injection. Topical anesthetics may be found in products that are sold over the counter or by prescription.

Based on their chemical structure, anesthetics belong to one of two classes – ester or amide. Cross reactions are more likely to occur within each family. It is important to understand which family of anesthetics you are sensitive to.

ANESTHETICS can also be known as:

- Chemicals ending in -caine

Some Possible Uses of ANESTHETICS /

Where it might be found:

- Itch remedy
- Insect bite relief
- Poison ivy treatment
- Hemorrhoid cream, suppository
- Vaginal anti-itch cream
- Desensitizing personal lubricant
- First aid antiseptic
- Sunburn prep and burn treatment
- Ulcer therapy
- Canker sore treatment
- Fever blister treatment
- Boil remedy
- Pain soothing salve
- Analgesic ointment
- Muscle liniment
- Denture adhesive
- Denture pain cream
- Toothache product
- Teething cream or gel
- Throat lozenge
- Sore throat spray
- Cough drop, lozenge, or spray

- Earache preparation
- Eye inflammation treatment
- Some athlete's foot remedies
- Some corn, callus, wart products
- Cracked heel cream
- Epilating wax, bikini gel
- Shave cream
- After shave, astringent
- Appetite suppressant
- Numbing injections

Other products that might react like ANESTHETICS:

Cross reactions usually occur within each family, ester or amide.

Cross reactions to anesthetics do not always perfectly stay within ester and amide groups. If you have an anesthetic allergy, it is best to get tested for all anesthetics that you might need to use, so that you can be sure which anesthetic is safe for you to use.

ESTER allergy may show cross reaction with:

- Azo aniline textile dyes
- Hydrochlorothiazide (*diuretic*)
- Para amino salicylic acid (PAS)
- Para aminobenzoic acid & glyceryl PABA (*sunscreens*)
- Paraben preservatives
- Paraphenylenediamine (*hair dyes*)
- Procainamide (e.g. *Pronestyl*)
- Sulfonamides (e.g. *sulfa antibiotics*)
- Sulfonylureas (*anti diabetic pills*)

What is okay to use?

People with *either* sensitivity can usually use:

- Pramoxine
- Diphenhydramine
- Dyclonine
- Saline injections

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What should I do to avoid ANESTHETICS?

People with sensitivity to anesthetics on patch testing may develop a localized skin rash from topically applied or injected anesthetics. Patients with this type of allergy are not likely to develop systemic symptoms such as anaphylaxis. Read the complete ingredient list on the label of all products you use now or buy for use on your skin, eyes, ears, or mucous membranes. *Please see the CAMP app for a list of products that do not contain the anesthetic chemical that you are allergic to.*

Cross reactions to anesthetics do not always perfectly stay within ester and amide groups.

These rules *usually* apply:

- If you are allergic to the **ester** group, avoid benzocaine, tetracaine, and all other members of this family.
- If you are allergic to the **amide** group, avoid lidocaine, dibucaine, and all other agents in this group—usually having 2 “i”s in their name

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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If you need to avoid Amides do **NOT** use:

- Bupivacaine (e.g. *Marcaine*, *Sensorcaine*)
- Dibucaine (e.g. *Nupercainal*, *Cinchocaine*, *Peracaine*)
- Etidocaine (e.g. *Duranest*)
- Lidocaine (e.g. *Xylocaine*)
- EMLA
- Mepivacaine (e.g. *Carbocaine*)
- Prilocaine (e.g. *Citanest*)
- Pyrrocaine (*Dynacaine*)

If you need to avoid Esters do **NOT** use:

- Benzocaine
- Tetracaine
- Amylocaine (e.g. *Stovaine*)
- Benoxinate (e.g. *Dorsacaine*)
- Benzamine (e.g. *B-eucaine*)
- Butacaine (e.g. *Butelline*)
- Butethamine (e.g. *Monocaine*)
- Chloroprocaine (e.g. *Nesacaine*)
- Cocaine (used in surgery)
- Hexylcaine (e.g. *Cyclaine*)
- Isobucaine (e.g. *Kincaine*)
- Meprylcaine (e.g. *Oracaine*)
- Metabutethamine (e.g. *Unacaine*)
- Metabutozycaine (e.g. *Primacaine*)
- Neapaine (e.g. *Amylsine*)
- Orthocaine (e.g. *Orthoform*, *Neo Orthoform*)
- Phenacaine
- Piperocaine (e.g. *Metycaine*)
- Procaine (e.g. *Novocain*)
- Proparacaine (e.g. *Alcaine*, *Opthaine*)
- Propoxycaine with 2% procaine (e.g. *Ravocaine*)
- Risocaine (e.g. *Propaesin*)